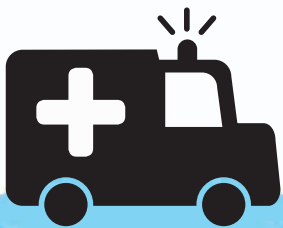


PARAMEDIC



SALARY

Newly qualified paramedic ★★★★★

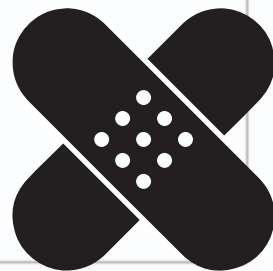
Senior paramedic ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Number of jobs set to grow • Most employment with ambulance and health service providers • Some opportunities in the armed forces

JOB DESCRIPTION

Paramedics are health care experts who usually work as part of an ambulance crew. When called to the scene of an accident or emergency, a paramedic assesses the patient's condition and provides essential, sometimes life-saving care. They are trained to deal with minor injuries, such as cuts and fractures, as well as critical health conditions, such as heart attacks or strokes.



CAREER PATHS

You must start out as an emergency medical technician (EMT) before training for the role of paramedic. Once licensed as a paramedic, there are opportunities for further training in clinical practice or in rapid-response units.

EMT After earning your high school degree, you can enroll in an EMT training program. This training is likely to include hands-on experience in the field.



GRADUATE Paramedic training programs can last up to two years and result in an associate's degree. After completing the training program and passing state exams, you can apply for work as a paramedic.



EMERGENCY CARE PARAMEDIC

Works alongside other medical staff in hospitals, prisons, or other institutions, providing emergency treatments on site. Further training is required to gain additional clinical skills.



PARAMEDIC With experience, you can specialize in heading up an emergency response team, which involves making quick decisions about surgical procedures and using advanced life support techniques.